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The 1-Minute Introduction That Makes People Remember You Forever

A Behavioral Scientist's Trick to Hack the "Halo Effect"

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2 min read · Mar 19, 2025



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The Day I Bombed My Introduction (And What I Learned)

“Hi, I’m... uh... John? I like... stuff?”

That’s how I introduced myself at a conference once. Spoiler: No one remembered me. Fast-forward to today — I use a *1-minute trick* that turns strangers into superfans. Here’s how to make your next introduction unforgettable (no “liking stuff” required).

Why Your Brain Hates Basic Intros

- **The “Broken Robot” Effect:** *“Name, job, hobby”* intros are predictable → brains tune out.
- **The Halo Effect:** People decide if you’re smart/kind/interesting in **seconds** — first impressions stick like glue.
- **Science Fix:** Use storytelling + curiosity to hijack their attention.

The 3-Part Formula (Steal This!)

1. The Hook: Start With a Story, Not Your Name

Bad: *“Hi, I’m Sarah, a marketer from Chicago.”*

Better: *“I once accidentally emailed 10,000 customers a cat meme. Now I teach companies how to avoid my mistakes.”*

- **Why:** Stories activate the brain’s “movie mode” → you’re memorable.

2. The Highlight: Add a “WTF” Detail

Bad: *“I love hiking.”*

Better: *“I climbed a mountain in flip-flops to prove my mom wrong.”*

- **Why:** Quirky details stick 5x longer (*Journal of Experimental Psychology*).

3. The Handoff: Make It About Them

Bad: *“Nice to meet you!”*

Better: *“What’s the weirdest hobby you’ve tried?”*

- **Why:** Questions force their brain to engage → they associate you with curiosity.

Real-Life Example: From “Who?” to “Wow!”

Before:

“I’m Alex. I work in data. I like reading.” → Forgotten in 10 seconds.

After:

“I spent 3 years tracking how 500 people brush their teeth. Now companies pay me to fix weird habits. What’s a habit you’d love to break?”

→ Result: *“Wait, you’re the Toothbrush Data Guy!”*

Your 7-Day Challenge

1. Day 1–2: Write your “Hook” (use the formula above).
2. Day 3–4: Practice saying it in the mirror (no cringing!).
3. Day 5–6: Test it on a friend (ask for honest feedback).
4. Day 7: Use it in real life (coffee shop, Zoom call, anywhere!).

Why This Works (Brain Science)

1. **Dopamine Hit:** Surprise triggers dopamine → brains *love* you.
2. **Mirror Neurons:** Stories make people “feel” your intro → emotional connection.
3. **Recency Bias:** End with a question → you’re the last thing they remember.

Tag Your “Forgettable Intro” Friend

- 🖐️ Clap if you’ve ever blanked during introductions.
- 💬 Comment your new “Hook” — we’ll help polish it!

-  Follow for part 2: *How to Turn Small Talk into Job Offers.*

PS Struggling? Drop your draft intro below — I'll turn it from “meh” to “WOW!” 😊

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Written by Alessia Fransisca

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Responses (100)





Sandesh Chand

What are your thoughts?



Robin Palmer
Mar 20 (edited)



Not too sure about this advice- seems aimed at follow-up small talk, and not the initial intro. I suspect that it may cause people to actively avoid you.



138



6 replies

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Hammy Kay
Mar 19



“Hi, I’m... uh... John? I like... stuff?”

Great article 🙌

but are you John or Alessia 😊



116



2 replies

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Sébastien 🦊 he
Mar 19



People decide if you’re smart/kind/interesting in seconds — first impressions stick like glue.

That's just lack of curiosity. Because people are used to others being uninteresting. Because others aren't curious. Self reinforcing cycle, yet which begins to loosen. In the meantime you're correct if you want to be seen you do have to grab their curiosity almost by force.

Thanks and best wishes!



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